IMPACT OF STORE LAYOUT ON BEHAVIOUR INTENTION: A PILOT STUDY IN A RETAIL STORE

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Abstract
The qualities of a store's layout are a vital factor affecting customer behaviour and a crucial determinant in constructing a retail image. This research examines the link between store layout characteristics and consumer behavioural intentions. Each store layout characteristic was examined to discover and quantify the link with their behavioural purpose. Various SPSS analyses, such as descriptive statistics, correlation analysis ANOVA and regression, are used to understand the consumers' responses to meteorological conditions. A total of 70 people completed the survey for this quantitative study. According to the researchers, only lighting and spatial layout influence customer behaviour.

Keywords: Store layouts, store layout characteristics, consumer behavioural intentions

1. Introduction
The retail sector is one with a high degree of competitiveness. A retail company's fortunes might rise or fall based on how quickly it can adapt to changing market conditions and how well it predicts and predicts customer trends. Businesses in the retail sector would do well to pay attention to the tastes and concerns of their customers. Designing a functional store layout is a top priority for every merchant. A store's layout is a significant factor in forging its retail identity since it affects how and what customers purchase. A store's layout is crucial because it affects customer flow, the atmosphere shoppers feel comfortable in, purchasing decisions, and overall efficiency. Planning a retail store's layout is a challenging endeavour. Customers' arrival patterns, the architecture of the building, the degree of service needed, the inventory mix, the need for adjacent aisles, and other considerations all play a role in the store's layout. Retail store layout may significantly impact how customers perceive a place and whether they approach or avoid a particular product or establishment. Providing customers with a memorable shopping experience has become a priority for many modern stores. The search, purchase, consumption, and post-sale stages are part of the consumer experience. All these factors significantly affect a retailer's approach to managing the customer experience and are intrinsically linked to designing a store's layout. Invented by Kotler in 1973, "store atmosphere" refers to the conscious creation of a retail space to elicit a desired emotional response from shoppers. Customers in a retail setting begin the decision-making process to make a purchase when they realise they have high expectations of the shop.
This theoretical method highlights the value of investigating shop layout features in elucidating customer buying behaviour, which has implications for customer loyalty. The change rate in the retail sector is unprecedented. It is characterised by a rise in competition and the sophistication and demands of consumers. Therefore, this research will examine how customers feel about the convenience store's service regarding their accessibility, quality, and value and how store layout elements influence their purchase behaviour.

2. Literature Review
Researchers have repeatedly probed store design and layout's psychological and sociological impacts on shoppers. The store's layout may influence consumers' preferences, as found by Danovan & Rossiter (1982) in the retail sector. They also said that stores might create a more inviting atmosphere by controlling staffing levels and encouraging positive changes in attitude. The research was conducted, but not just concerning super/hypermarket forms. Levy et al. (2012) and Bell and Ternus (2006) define

layout as the "efficient flow of usable space, traffic management, and sales productivity" of a retail store to guarantee customer satisfaction and a positive first impression.
According to Juel-Jacobsen (2015), the approach to space management begins not with the placement of shelves and the classification of items but with a focus on the retailer's desired customer experiences and behaviour. Unfortunately, most stores nowadays do not put much thought into how their aisles are laid out, even though this is crucial to customer flow. The primary reason for this is that storefront real estate is so highly valued by businesses, making it less of a priority for these establishments to prioritise the layout of their walkways. One possible reason for this shift in attention is that performance metrics for shelf-space management and psychological products are more readily available in contrast to route design.

Anic et al. (2010) attempted to discover a link between customer traffic flow and store traffic on consumer expenditure in supermarkets in their study. Both of these were proven to have a beneficial effect on consumers' purchasing behaviour when combined. However, they claim that although traffic flow benefits product sales, other variables have a more significant impact. To maximise the impact of their product offerings, shops should design their layouts such that customers not only browse through a wide variety of aisles throughout their visits but also buy from a wide variety of aisles. The layout style they choose for their shops is crucial to this end.

The intensity of the impact of product promotions in retail contexts was investigated by Philips et al. (2015) using a research design that combined a promotional product demonstration with an end-of-aisle product display. They conclude that a product demonstration area and display are essential for successful product promotion. However, stores must consider the demo's surroundings to make it work. Product demos, according to them, are most successful when set up at the far end of an aisle, away from the actual product displays. In addition, they claim that advertising a product in two different ways (during a product demonstration and a product display) is counterproductive.

According to Nordfält and Lange (2013), the placement of product displays is crucial to the success of promotions. According to them, a product display is most effective in a high-traffic business area—possibly not the most shocking result, but something to keep in mind when placing store fixtures. A successful marketing display could be located at the store's entrance, but after customers have passed that area, they may forget about the offer. Stilly et al. (2010) . 's notion that consumers respond less to "early promotions" because customers initially concentrate on their intended purchases recorded in a shopping list might explain this phenomenon.

Shukla & Babin (2013). The study examines how different demographics and retail features influence consumers' utility and pleasure. The results show that their deal-seeking tendencies and social norms directly impact individuals' perceived worth in buying. The research also accounts for the impact of other store features, including product variety, after-sale care, and atmosphere. This research also demonstrates the impact that retailer-controlled factors have on the value that consumers obtain from their purchases. The findings light the role that various aspects of the retail space play in shaping customers' perceptions of the value they get from their purchases, opening the door to deliberate alterations that may improve the customer experience and boost total value. The findings contribute significantly by showing how factors under the control of retailers may affect the perceived value of a purchase made by a customer. The results also highlight the significance of shopping value in switching retailers.

Shop design has significantly influenced customer behaviour in brick-and-mortar and digital environments. Krasonikolaki (2018) research aims to determine whether and how store layout affects customers' buying decisions in a retail setting. According to the study results, different store layouts affect customers' satisfaction, excitement, and ease of navigation when purchasing online. The "department" layout is similar to conventional department shops and offers shoppers a fun and engaging

shopping experience, while the "pragmatic" structure places more emphasis on minimal system needs. The "warehouse" plan uses wide aisles to showcase items, making it easy to compare prices. At the same time, the "boutique" layout was rated highest by customers for providing a pleasant and exciting shopping experience.

Vrechopoulos et al. (2004) found that the physical layout of a store was one of the most critical factors in establishing a company's identity among consumers. The store's layout is one of the most critical factors in how well it does business because of its effect on foot traffic, the mood created, how customers respond, and the store's general efficiency.

Further, a customer's choice is affected by several elements and traits, such as the customer's buying patterns, purchasing behaviour, and brand preferences (Ramya & Ali, 2016). Understanding what influences people to make purchases is the focus of consumer purchasing behaviour (Niazi et al., 2012). Ahuja (2015) argues that people's purchase decisions consider the impact of social influences such as those exerted by family, friends, reference groups, and the larger community. Consumers' choices may also be influenced by cultural norms, societal forces, individuals' personalities and experiences, and consumers' psychological states.

Kang et al. (2010) found that customers were more likely to purchase when they were exposed to appealing images, such as music, aromas, lighting, and fabrics that made them feel comfortable. The inclination to buy, spend more money in a transaction, return to a business, tell others about a great experience, and have trust in the neighbourhood are all examples of consumers' behavioural intentions. According to several research, intentions to act are a strong indicator of future actions. Kang et al. (2010) found that personal referrals from friends and family account for over half of all retail sales.

Stores should aim for layouts encouraging consumers to browse more thoroughly and make impulse purchases (Levy & Weitz, 2007). This exercise will boost shop efficiency, alter consumers' perceptions of service providers, and help individuals classify service providers (Baker et al., 2002)

3. Objectives

- To determine the essential characteristics of the layout of the retail store.
- To determine how store layout characteristics would affect behavioural intentions.
- To determine the relationship between demographic variables and store layout characteristics
- To determine the relationship between demographic variables and behavioural intentions

4. Hypothesis

- H1: There is a significant relationship between Store layout Characteristics and customers' behavioural intentions.
- H2: There is a significant relationship between demographic variables and Store layout.
- H3: There is a significant relationship between demographic variables and customers' behavioural intentions.

5. Methodology

The study was quantitative and exploratory since it was undertaken to understand the problem's nature better. Since this is a pilot study, we have considered only 50 samples. Under non-probability sampling, the convenient and available sample was selected. The sample is spread over various parts of the city and is from various strata of society. The questionnaire was divided into demographics, store layout characteristics and behaviour intention. The study will use descriptive statistics, regression, ANOVA, and correlation tests to evaluate the data.

6. Result and Discussion

More factors than pricing and assortment contribute to a successful retail establishment. Low prices and a wide selection of products may draw customers in, but these factors alone are insufficient to generate sales. Displays for merchandise must be both aesthetically pleasing and practical.

Retail store designs should be customer-centric. The store's layout should be considered with the customer's convenience in mind. The layout of your shop should entice people to look around and buy anything.

The researchers identified the essential features of movement/circulation, spatial planning, and lighting. Movement management around the store mainly controls traffic flow. Conditions outside of your control should not prevent customers from quickly and easily purchasing what you provide.

The retail store layout is crucially dependent on the flow of customers. The aisles of a shop with poor traffic flow will typically be uneven, twisting, and trimming. They fail to achieve your ultimate aim of encouraging people to browse the shop and make a purchase. Customer satisfaction is affected due to the chaos caused by the traffic flow to your shop

Spatial planning is figuring out where and how to put things in a shop to maximise sales. This may be done to make products more noticeable and appealing to customers or to ensure there are always enough on the shelf or display. Moreover, It is crucial to have enough lighting while designing a store. Make sure the lighting in the store draws attention to the merchandise. Products look better and sell better when they are displayed in well-lit areas. As a result, clients are more likely to be in the mood to buy your wares once they have been inspired to feel good. Do not skimp by installing low-quality lighting only to save money. The satisfaction of our clients will suffer as a result of this

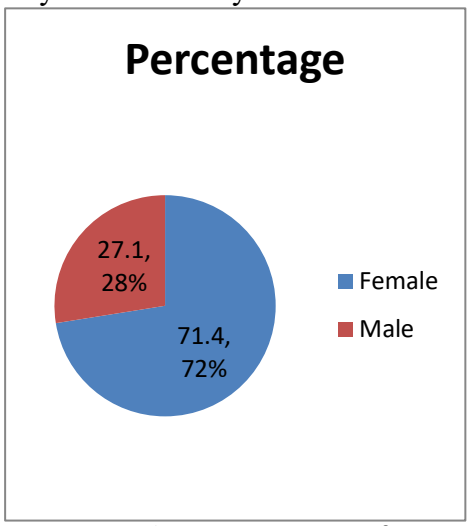


Figure 1: Gender Representation of Respondents

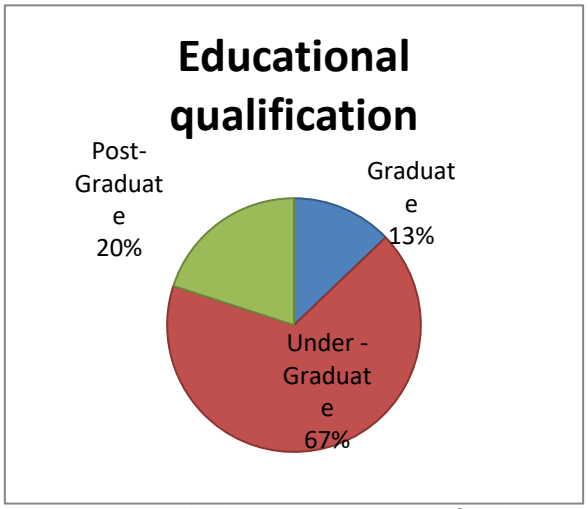


Figure 2: Graphical representation of Education qualifications of respondents

The graph above shows that of 70 respondents, 50 (71.4%) are female, and 20 (27.1%) are male. Of the total of 70 respondents, 9 (12.9%) had completed their education up to the point of graduation, 47 (67.1%) had completed their education up to the point of undergrad, and the remaining 14 (20%) had completed their education up to the point of post-graduation.

Out Of 70 respondents, 55 answered "yes" to whether or not they often shopped at the business, while 15 said "no." This suggests that a maximum of responders are frequent customers of the store. Most respondents said "Shoppers Shop," followed by "Reliance Retail", when asked which departmental retail establishments they had recently visited. Most respondents asked how frequently they visited a retail store said monthly, followed by weekly (4) and fortnightly (9). Moreover, when asked how long they often spent in stores, most said more than 30 minutes.

Table 1: Descriptive statistics

Variables	Mean	Std. Deviation	Variance
Gender	1.7429	.47199	.223
Education	2.0714	.57285	.328
Movement or circulation	2.3917	.50388	.254
Spatial planning	2.7881	.44384	.197
Lighting	2.5229	.60173	.362
Behavioural intentions	2.4064	.65474	.429

The features of the data utilised in the research are summarised in the table above, with the mean value for demographic variables like gender being the lowest and the mean value for shop layout characteristics like spatial planning being the highest (1.7429). The standard deviation also captures variability. Because of this, we may describe the data's variability using the same units as the data itself. If the data points are clustered near the mean, the standard deviation is slight, and if it is large, the data points are dispersed widely. The maximum standard deviation was found for behavioural intents (0.65474), and the minor standard deviation was recorded for shop layout elements like spatial planning (0.44384). The coefficient of variation for behavioural intentions to act was 0.429, whereas that of the store's physical layout elements, such as its spatial planning, was just0 .197.

H1: There is a significant relationship between Store layout Characteristics and customers' behavioural intentions.

Table 2: Correlation analysis between Store layout Characteristics and customer behavioural intentions.

		Movement	Spatial planning	Lighting	Behavioral intentions
Movement	Pearson Correlation	1	.281*	-.068	-.010
	Sig. (2-tailed)		.018	.577	.937
	N	70	70	70	70
Spatial planning	Pearson Correlation	.281*	1	-.075	-.106
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.018		.539	.383
	N	70	70	70	70
Lighting	Pearson Correlation	-.068	-.075	1	.516**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.577	.539		.000
	N	70	70	70	70
Behavioral intentions	Pearson Correlation	-.010	-.106	.516**	1
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.937	.383	.000	
	N	70	70	70	70
*. Correlation is significant at the 0.05 level (2-tailed).					
**. Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed).					

Both lighting (.516**) and spatial planning (.281*) are positively and significantly correlated with behavioural intentions (seen in the store layout). At the same time, there were no statistically significant associations found between the other factors.

A positive correlation suggests a strong relationship between the two variables; that is, changes in one variable often have the same effect on the other.

Table 3: Model Summary of regression analysis

Model Summary				
Model	**R**	**R Square**	**Adjusted R Square**	**Std. The error in the Estimate**
Linear	.522	.273	.240	.57088

The R and R2 values are shown above in the table. The R-value, which reflects the simple correlation, is 0.522, indicating a medium level of relationship. The R2 score (0.273) reflects how much of the overall variance in the dependent variable, i.e. behavioural intentions, can be explained by all independent factors. In this scenario, 73% can be explained, which is significant. In identifying the independent factors that significantly impact the dependent variable (in this case, behavioural intentions), we calculated an adjusted R2 value of 0.240.

Table 4 ANOVA table of regression analysis

Model	**Sum of Squares**	**df**	**Mean Square**	**F**	**Sig.**

Regression	8.070	3	2.690	8.254	.000
Residual	21.510	66	.326		
Total	29.580	69			

The table above shows that the regression model accurately predicts the dependent variable. The F statistics value (8.254) was less than 1% (0.000), indicating a substantial influence on the dependent variable.

Table 5: Coefficients of regression analysis

Model	**Unstandardised Coefficients**		**Standardised Coefficients**	**t**	**Sig.**
	B	**Std. Error**	**Beta**		
(Constant)	1.182	.589		2.006	.049
Movement	.062	.142	.048	.438	.663
Spatial planning	-.119	.162	-.081	-.739	.463
Lighting	.558	.115	.513	4.869	.000
Dependent Variable: Behavioral intentions					

. The coefficients of regression analysis are shown in the table above. Lighting (4.869) exhibited significant regression coefficients with t-test significance levels of less than 1% among the variables tested. The remainder of the variables were considered non-significant since their significance level was more than 5%. As a result, we concluded that shop layout factors, namely lighting, had a substantial influence on the dependent variable, namely behavioural intentions.

H2: There is a significant relationship between demographic variables and Store layout

Table 6: Correlation analysis

		Movement	**Spatial planning**	**Lighting**	**Gender**	**Education**
Movement	**Pearson Correlation**	1	.281*	-.068	.018	-.048
	Sig. (2-tailed)		.018	.577	.881	.692
	N	70	70	70	70	70
Spatial planning	**Pearson Correlation**	.281*	1	-.075	-.143	.003
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.018		.539	.238	.978
	N	70	70	70	70	70
Lighting	**Pearson Correlation**	-.068	-.075	1	-.081	.176
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.577	.539		.505	.145
	N	70	70	70	70	70
Gender	**Pearson Correlation**	.018	-.143	-.081	1	.015
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.881	.238	.505		.900
	N	70	70	70	70	70
Education	**Pearson Correlation**	-.048	.003	.176	.015	1
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.692	.978	.145	.900	
	N	70	70	70	70	70
*. Correlation is significant at the 0.05 level (2-tailed).						

The above table shows that only Spatial planning (.281*) (store layout attributes) had positive and substantial associations with Movement or circulation (store layout characteristics). While the remaining factors revealed no significant relationships,

A positive correlation indicates that the connection between two variables tends to move in the same direction, which implies that changes in one variable have the same response as changes in the other variable.

H3: There is a significant relationship between demographic variables and customers' behavioural intentions.

H3: There is a significant relationship between demographic variables and customers' behavioural intentions.

Table 7: Correlation analysis between demographic variables and customer's behavioural intentions

		Gender	Education	Behavioural intentions
Gender	**Pearson Correlation**	1	.015	-.119
	Sig. (2-tailed)		.900	.327
	N	70	70	70
Education	**Pearson Correlation**	.015	1	.231
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.900		.055
	N	70	70	70
Behavioural intentions	**Pearson Correlation**	-.119	.231	1
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.327	.055	
	N	70	70	70

According to the correlations table above, demographic variables exhibited a non-significant relationship with consumer behavioural intentions.

Table 8 Model Summary of regression analysis

Model	R	R Square	Adjusted R Square	Std. The error in the Estimate
Linear	.261	.068	.040	.64140

The R and R2 values are shown in the table above. The R-value, which shows the simple correlation, is 0.261, indicating a medium level of relationship.

The R2 (.068) value reflects how much of the overall variance in the dependent variable, i.e. behavioural intentions, can be explained by all independent factors. In this example, 90% of the explanation is quite vast.

While searching for the adjusted R2 value (0.040) that can be explained by those independent factors that have a meaningful impact on the dependent variable behavioural intentions.

Table 9 ANOVA table of regression analysis

Model	Sum of Squares	df	Mean Square	F	Sig.
Regression	2.016	2	1.008	2.450	.094
Residual	27.564	67	.411		
Total	29.580	69			

The table above shows that the regression model accurately predicts the dependent variable. The F statistics value (2.450) was non-significant, indicating that the dependent variable had no effect.

Table 10: coefficients of regression analysis

Model	Unstandardised Coefficients		Standardised Coefficients	t	Sig.
	B	Std. Error	Beta		
(Constant)	2.152	.403		5.335	.000
Gender	-.170	.164	-.122	-1.038	.303
Education	.266	.135	.232	1.971	.053
Dependent Variable: Behavioural intentions					

The coefficients of regression analysis are shown in the table above. All the factors tested were considered non-significant owing to a significance level greater than 5%.

7 Conclusions

The influence of store layout characteristics on customer behaviours at a retail store was investigated in this research. Retailers must execute a retail strategy; it might be inferred. However, many researchers conducted a generic study on shop layout features rather than focusing explicitly on the sort of nature company or retail store. Various establishments have distinct perspectives on atmospheric characteristics since they sell different products. For this research, three store layout elements are being investigated to determine each variable's influence on consumer behavioural intention. Only lighting and spatial planning are strongly and positively connected to behavioural intentions. Demographic factors had no statistically significant link with customer behavioural intentions or shop layout parameters. This study's null hypothesis has been rejected in support of an alternative hypothesis.

It is advised that qualitative research be done to understand more about convenience store architecture and its influence on customer buying behaviour. Aside from that, the future study may look at other aspects of retail char, like temperature, cleanliness, amenities, design, and aroma, since all of these variables are vital in creating appealing store characteristics. Future research may also look at additional shop characteristics from other retail businesses or sectors, such as fashion, electronics, convenience, pharmacy, etc. Various researchers may observe other aspects of customer assessment, such as loyalty, retention, purchase choice, contentment, expectation, needs, desires, perception, and many more, in addition to consumers' experiences and behavioural intentions. On the other hand, the researcher may do a specialised study on one of the shop attributes, such as investigating the influence of visual merchandising on the customer's purchase choice. It is because performing more thorough research allows the researcher to concentrate on the specified issues without worrying about deviations.

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